SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #59 · FAITH & BELIEF

“My faith is only as strong as my feelings.”

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Where it often comes from

Church experiences that focused on emotional highs. Feeling spiritually strong only after retreats, worship nights, or revivals. Depression or exhaustion that made faith feel weak. Hearing that a real Christian always feels on fire for God. Comparing your feelings with others’ expressions of faith.

What Scripture teaches

Faith is trust in God and His Word, not a feeling. We walk by faith, not by sight. Faith is the assurance of what we hope for and the certainty of what we do not see. It comes by hearing the word of Christ. In Lamentations, the writer felt crushed, yet he called to mind God’s faithfulness and found hope. Feelings rise and fall; God’s faithfulness does not.

> *“For we walk by faith, not by sight”* **(2 Corinthians 5:7)**.

Also see

> “Now faith is the assurance of what we hope for and the certainty of what we do not see” **(Hebrews 11:1)**.

> “Consequently, faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of Christ” **(Romans 10:17)**.

> “Yet I call this to mind, and therefore I have hope: Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!” **(Lamentations 3:21–23)**.

> “Though the fig tree does not bud and no fruit is on the vines, though the olive crop fails and the fields produce no food, though the sheep are cut off from the fold and no cattle are in the stalls, yet I will exult in the LORD; I will rejoice in the God of my salvation!” **(Habakkuk 3:17–18)**.

Common self-statements

- I don’t feel anything, so my faith must be weak.
- I’m only close to God when I feel it.
- My faith comes and goes with my mood.
- If I don’t feel excited, I must be backsliding.
- Real faith always feels strong.
- I need another spiritual high.

Common logical errors

- **Emotional reasoning:** Measuring faith by how you feel.
- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing faith is either fully felt or absent.
- **Overgeneralization:** Turning one dry day into “my faith is gone.”
- **Comparison:** Measuring your faith by others’ emotions.

Challenging questions

- What does it mean to walk by faith, not by sight?

- Is faith a feeling or trust in God's promises?
- What did the writer of Lamentations do when he felt crushed?
- Where does faith come from, according to Romans 10:17?
- Have my feelings ever been low while my trust remained?
- Is God's faithfulness affected by my mood?
- What could I do to strengthen faith on a day I feel nothing?

Truth summary

> My faith is not only as strong as my feelings. Faith is trust in God and His Word. I walk by faith, not by sight or feeling. My emotions rise and fall, but God's faithfulness is great and His mercies are new every morning. I can strengthen my faith by hearing His Word.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Faith
- Trust
- Scripture/Word
- Belief
- Joy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My faith is only as strong as my feelings"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My faith is only as strong as my feelings." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does it mean to walk by faith?
- ☐ Is faith a feeling or trust?
- ☐ What did Lamentations' writer call to mind?
- ☐ Where does faith come from?
- ☐ Have I trusted God when I felt low?
- ☐ Is God's faithfulness affected by my mood?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I walk by faith, not by feelings.
- ☐ Faith is trust in God and His Word.
- ☐ My feelings rise and fall; God's faithfulness does not.
- ☐ Faith comes by hearing the word of Christ.
- ☐ I can call to mind God's faithfulness and have hope.
- ☐ I can rejoice in God even when I feel little.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **2 Corinthians 5:7**
  "For we walk by faith, not by sight."
- [ ] **Hebrews 11:1**
  "Now faith is the assurance of what we hope for and the certainty of what we do not see."
- [ ] **Romans 10:17**
  "Consequently, faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of Christ."
- [ ] **Lamentations 3:21–23**
  "Yet I call this to mind, and therefore I have hope: Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"
- [ ] **Habakkuk 3:17–18**
  "Though the fig tree does not bud and no fruit is on the vines, though the olive crop fails and the fields produce no food, though the sheep are cut off from the fold and no cattle are in the stalls, yet I will exult in the LORD; I will rejoice in the God of my salvation!"

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Faith steps log:** Each day, write one action I took in faith, whether or not I felt anything.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Lamentations 3:21–23 becomes: "Yet **Sarah** calls this to mind, and therefore **she** has hope: Because of the loving devotion of the LORD **she** is not consumed, for His mercies never fail."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Faith" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Read Scripture for ten minutes each day this week,** whether or not you feel like it.
- ☐ **Write a list of God's past faithfulness** in your life and read it on low days.
- ☐ **Do one act of obedience this week** that you don't feel like doing, and notice what happens.
- ☐ **Read Hebrews 11,** and note how many faithful people acted without seeing the results.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My faith is only as strong as my feelings": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One faith step I took
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My faith is only as strong as my feelings.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that my faith rests on You and Your Word, not on my feelings. Help me reject the lie that my faith is only as strong as my feelings. Teach me to walk by faith, to call to mind Your faithfulness, and to keep trusting You on dry days. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.